

STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STANDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

PHASE 7 PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

7.1 Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

7.2 User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimizing manual intervention.

7.3 Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

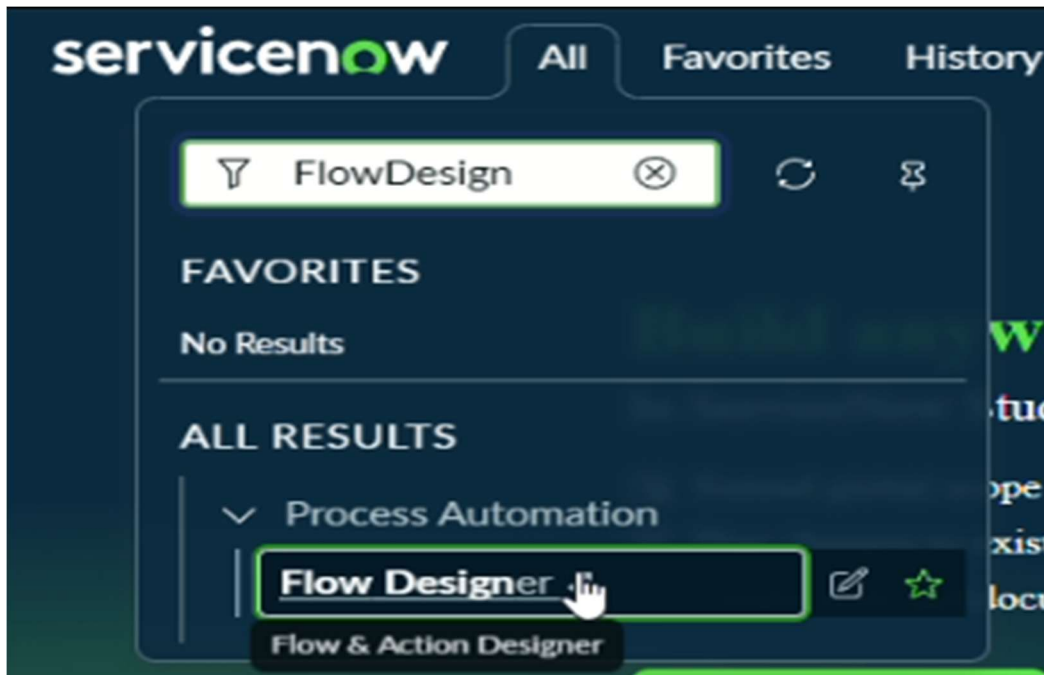
- Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
- Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
- Improve resource utilization within the IT department by optimizing task allocation.
- Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

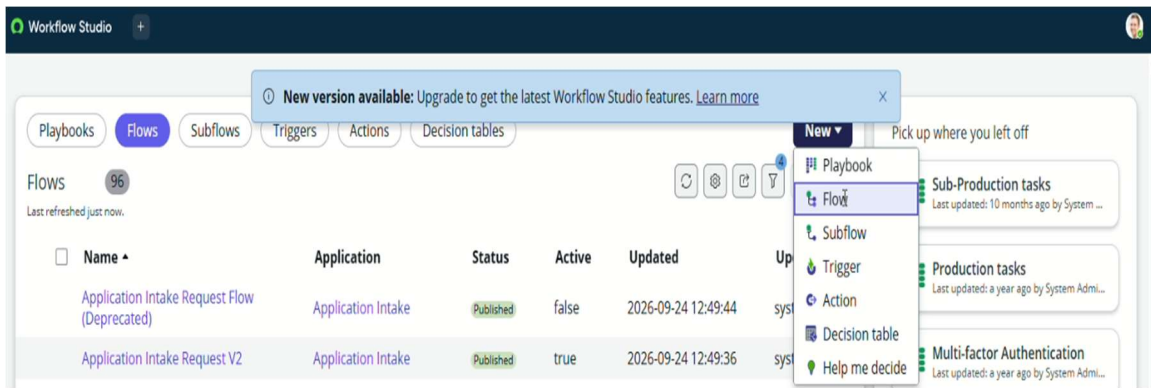
7.4 TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.





Let's get the details for your flow

Flow name * ⓘ

Standard laptop task

Application * ⓘ

Global

Description ⓘ

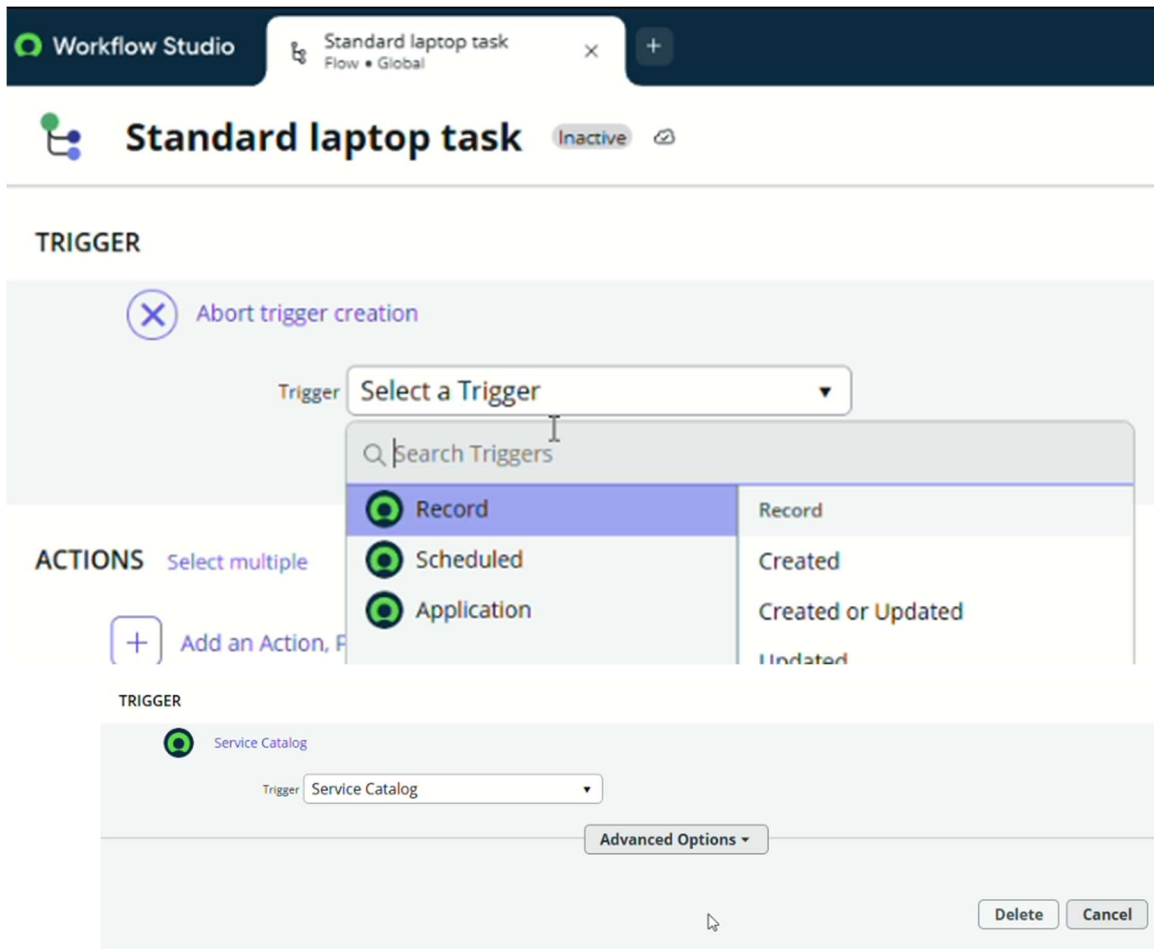
Describe your flow.

> Show additional properties

Cancel

Build flow

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.



12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

Standard laptop task Inactive

TRIGGER



ACTIONS Select multiple

× ➔ Action ⚙️ Flow Logic 🔗 Subflow

ERROR HANDLING
If an error occurs

INSTALLED SPOKES

- ServiceNow Core
- AES Catalog Builder
- AES Flow Templates
- AES Mobile Templates
- AES Portal UI Template
- App Engine Studio
- Application Intake
- Collaboration Request
- Collaboration Services for

Default

- Ask For Approval
- Create or Update Record
- Create Record
- Create Task
- Service Catalog
- Create Catalog Task
- Record Producer
- Submit Catalog Item Request

Standard laptop task Inactive View: 1

Action Properties

Action: Create Catalog Task

Action Inputs

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger -> Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop need to Configured

Description: Laptop need to Configured

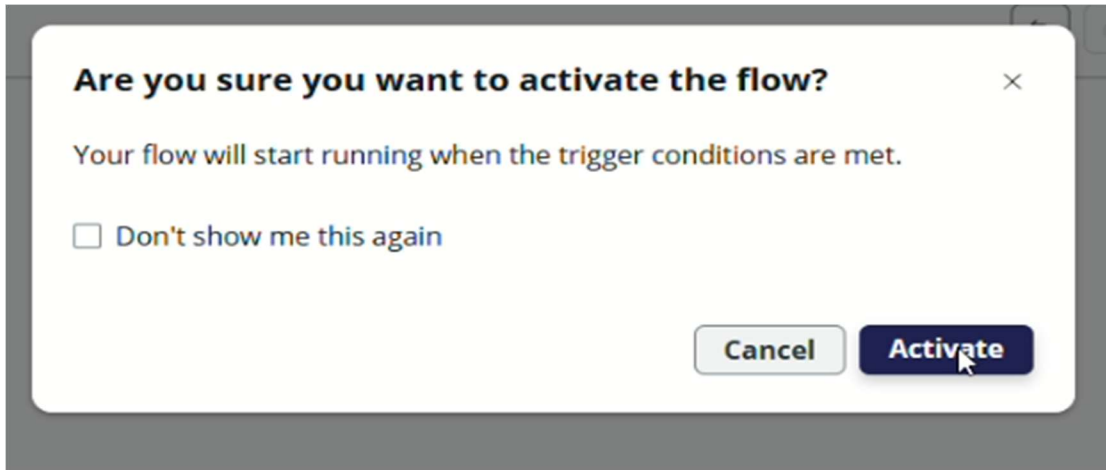
Assignment group: Hardware

Fields: Approval Approved

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow Catalog Items interface. The top navigation bar includes 'All', 'Favorites', 'History', 'Workspaces', and 'Admin'. The 'Catalog Items' tab is active. A search bar is present, and a filter path is shown: 'All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published item is empty > Name >= Standard Laptop'.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
StarTech Mini Display Port to DVI Adapter	PC / Mac Compatible	false		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$17.23	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

The 'Standard Laptop' item is selected, and its details are shown in the 'Catalog Item Standard Laptop' form. The form includes fields for 'Catalogs' (Service Catalog), 'Category' (Hardware), 'State' (None), 'Checked out' (None), 'Owner', and 'Secondary owners'. The 'Active' checkbox is checked, and the 'Fulfillment automation level' is set to 'Unspecified'.

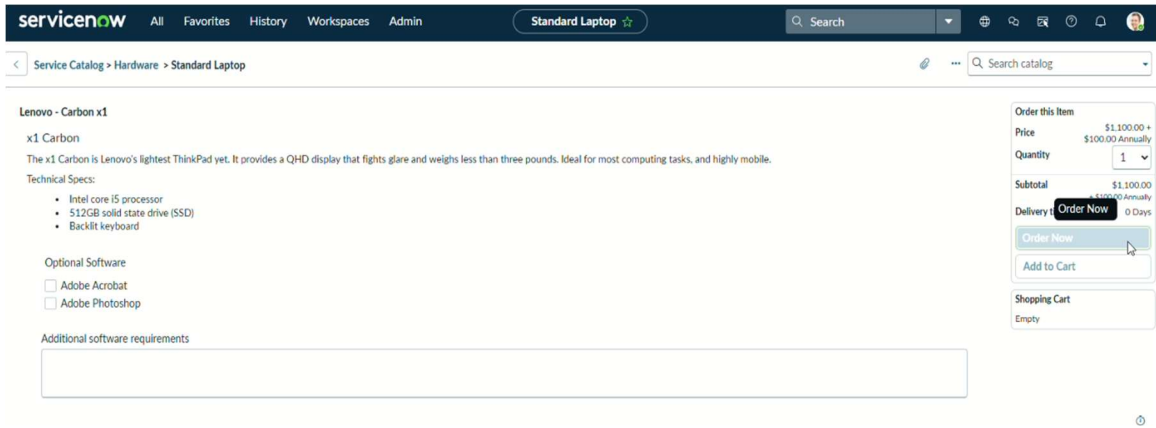
The 'Item Details' tab is active, showing a message: 'Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.' Below this, there are fields for 'Flow' (Standard laptop task), 'Workflow', and 'Execution Plan', each with a search icon.

At the bottom, there are buttons for 'Copy', 'Try It', 'Update', 'Edit in Catalog Builder', and 'Delete'. A 'Related Links' section shows 'Item Diagnostic'.

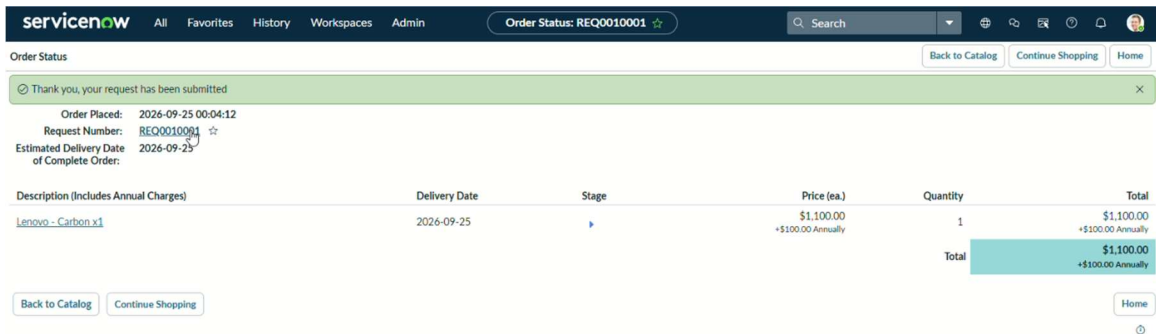
Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

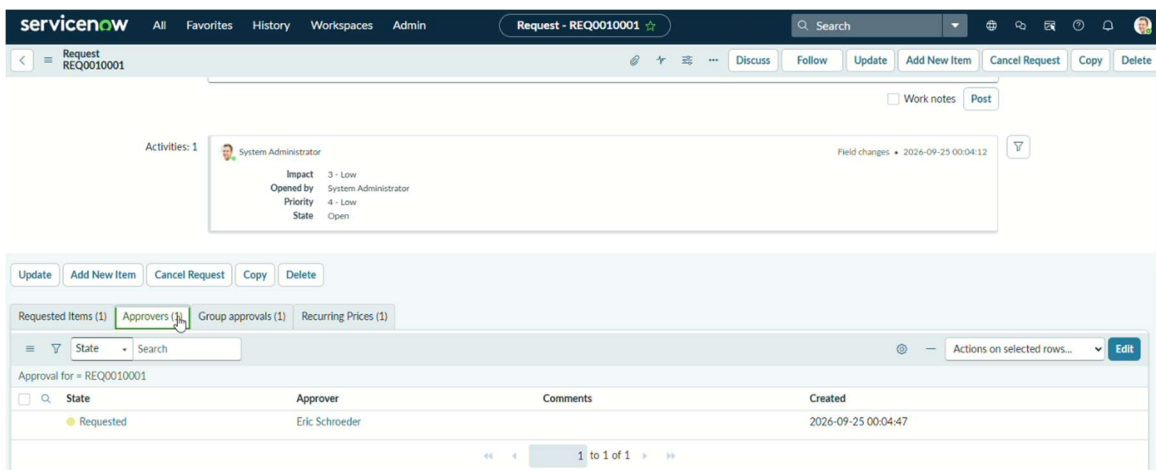
1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



5. Now we will see the Order status
6. In that click on the Request Number



7. It will open the Requested number record.
8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.



9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin **Approval - Request: REQ0010001** Search

Approval Request: REQ0010001

Summary of Request being approved:

Opened by: System Administrator
Requested for: System Administrator
Total: \$1,100.00

Status	Number	Description	Price	Quantity	Total
Deny Accept	RITM0010001	Lenovo - Carbon x1	\$1,100.00	1	\$1,100.00

Comments

Activities: 1

System Administrator
Approver State
Eric Schroeder
Requested

Field changes • 2026-09-25 00:04:47

Update Approve Reject Delete

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

servicenow All Favorites History Workspaces Admin **Requested Item - RITM0010001** Search

Requested Item RITM0010001

Activities: 1

System Administrator
Impact 3 - Low
Opened by System Administrator
State Open

Field changes • 2026-09-25 00:04:11

Update Delete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers

Request Item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop need to Configured	2026-09-25 00:06:06	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short Description and Assigned group.

Catalog Task
SCTASK0010001

Number: SCTASK0010001

Assigned to: [Search]

Configuration item: [Search]

Active: ☒

Approval: Approved

Priority: -- None --

State: Open

Request item: RITM0010001

Requested for: System Administrator

Short description: Laptop need to Configured

Description: Laptop need to Configured

Comments (Customer visible): [Text area]

Work notes: ☐ Post

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact: 3 - Low

Opened by: System Administrator

State: Open

Field changes: 2024-09-25 00:06:06

7.5 Administrator Guide

Administrator Steps

Create and activate the Standard laptop task flow. Configure the Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action. Assign the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item through Process engine. Verify the resulting Catalog Task after approval.

7.6 Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

7.7 Final Project Report

Report Summary

The final report should contain the problem statement, user story, project objectives, implementation milestones, configuration steps, validation evidence, and conclusion documented in the supplied project source.